



WASHINGTON, DC CIVIC JOURNEY · 8TH GRADE · APRIL 14 TO 18, 2027

What People Said

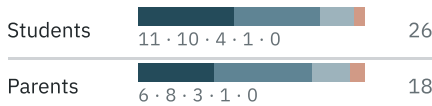
Addressed to Jordan Patel, Head of Middle School, and Emily Carter, trip leader. Onward circulation is the school's decision.

Every group was asked the same four questions: three rated, shown as bars below, and one open question asking for a single moment, which the moments below are drawn from. 26 of 30 students answered, in homeroom on the Monday after the trip; 18 of 30 parent households answered; the trip leader, the co-leader, the school nurse and the three chaperones, and Lakefront Student Transportation, answered as a named debrief.

Overall

Excellent to Poor

Overall, how was the trip for you? · parents: overall, how was the trip for your child?



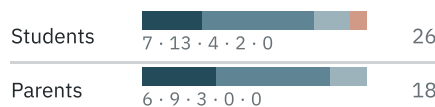
Fair or Poor: 1 student · 1 parent

Leaders: Very good, Very good, Good, Very good, Good, Very good · Provider: Very good

The plan

Exactly to Not at all

Was the trip like what you were told it would be? · parents: how closely did the trip match what the school told you to expect?



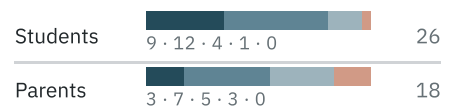
Not much or Not at all: 2 students

Leaders: Mostly, Mostly, Mostly, Partly, Mostly, Mostly · Provider: Mostly

The days

Extremely well to Not at all well

How well were you looked after during the trip? · parents: how well were you kept informed while the trip was away?



Not very well or Not at all well: 1 student · 3 parents

Leaders: Very well, Fairly well, Very well, Very well, Fairly well, Very well · Provider: Very well

Each bar runs from the top of the scale (left) to the bottom (right): ■ top ■ ■ ■ bottom. The counts under each bar are the answers at each step of the scale; the number after it is how many answered.

Moments that did not go to plan

the three most raised · with the day, and whether each points at the plan or at how the day was run · all eight, with every quote, on pages 4 and 5

Communication with parents · evening update

7 of 51

On D3, parents described waiting for the evening update after the memorial walk, which reached families after ten, later than on the other evenings; the trip leaders described the same gap between the room check and the message home.

parent, student, the trip leaders

D3 RUNNING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

"The Friday message came at 10:15. Every other night it was 7 or 8, so I was watching my phone." parent · D3

Weather and conditions · cold and rain on the walk

6 of 51

On D3, students described being cold and wet between the Vietnam Veterans Memorial and the Lincoln Memorial after rain began during the walk, with rain jackets left on the bus; one parent described a student coming home with a cold.

student, parent

D3 RUNNING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

"it started raining at the vietnam wall and my sweatshirt was soaked by the time we got to lincoln" student · D3 · Memorial walk

The plan · what students were told to expect

5 of 51

On D2, students and the trip leaders described a forty-minute security line at the Capitol Visitor Center that left no time for the Supreme Court steps, the stop the plan had marked to drop first; students who had been told about the Supreme Court in class recorded the loss.

student, the trip leaders

D2 PROGRAMMING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

"we waited in the capitol line forever and then didn't get to go to the supreme court which we did a whole lesson on" student · D2 · U.S. Capitol

For the School's Review

What the responses show and what in the trip it touches. No recommendation: the decision on each finding sits with the school.



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Parents answered less favorably than students on the days question, and the evidence from D3, the evening update that reached families after the room check, points at how the day was run rather than at the plan.

The Supreme Court stop on D2 was dropped as the plan allowed, and students who had prepared for it in class recorded the loss; that evidence points at what people were told to expect, which is the plan.

The overnight return arrived after the window and the moments raised about it, the 2:15 a.m. stop and tired students on Sunday, point at the plan, not at how the night was run.

Raised by more than one group: Communication with parents · evening update (parent, student, the trip leaders); Weather and conditions · cold and rain on the walk (student, parent); The plan · what students were told to expect (student, the trip leaders); Wellbeing and pastoral care · rest on the overnight return (student, parent); Transport and logistics · arrival time (parent, the provider).

Also raised last year: first run of this instrument for this trip, so there is no prior run to compare.

What went well, in their words: *"the archives educator let us look at the real constitution up close and explained why the ink is so faded"* (student); *"Same chaperone all week, five kids each. She knew where he was every minute and so did I."* (parent).

Who answered

GROUP	INVITED	ANSWERED	RATE	WROTE A MOMENT	TREATMENT
Students	30	26	87%	19 of 26	Reported in full, anonymous
Parents	30	18	60%	13 of 18	Reported in full, anonymous
Leaders	6	6	100%	6 of 6	Named debrief, attributed by role
Provider	1	1	100%	1 of 1	Named debrief, attributed by role

Parents against students

a gap of half a point or more is printed as a finding

QUESTION	PARENTS	STUDENTS	GAP	AT OR ABOVE THE BAND
Overall	4.1	4.2	-0.1	no
The plan	4.2	4.0	+0.2	no
The days	3.6	4.1	-0.6	yes

Survey window Monday, April 19 to Monday, May 3, 2027, one reminder. Groups below 5 responses are withheld, words and numbers alike. Trip leaders and the provider answered as a named debrief, attributed by role. The welfare channel was used; its content went to the school's designated welfare contact and is not described here. Distributions and counts are computed by rule from the response set; sentences are written from the responses and checked word for word against them. This report does not recommend, does not establish cause, and reads a sample: those who answer are not always representative of those who do not.



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The Three Rated Questions, by Group

51 responses from 67 invited. Rated responses are counted per group. Anonymous groups below 5 responses are withheld. Trip leaders and the provider answered the same questions as a named debrief and are shown as the words they chose, never as a mean. Means are printed for year-on-year comparison only; the distribution is the finding.

Overall • Excellent to Poor

Students: Overall, how was the trip for you? • Parents: Overall, how was the trip for your child? • Leaders: Overall, how did the trip go? • Provider: Overall, how did this trip run?

GROUP	ANSWERED	DISTRIBUTION, TOP OF THE SCALE TO BOTTOM	MEAN	FAIR OR POOR
Students	26	 11 · 10 · 4 · 1 · 0	4.2	1
Parents	18	 6 · 8 · 3 · 1 · 0	4.1	1
Leaders	6	Very good, Very good, Good, Very good, Good, Very good		
Provider	1	Very good		

The plan • Exactly to Not at all

Students: Was the trip like what you were told it would be? • Parents: How closely did the trip match what the school told you to expect? • Leaders: How well did the itinerary hold up in practice? • Provider: How realistic was the itinerary as planned, for this group?

GROUP	ANSWERED	DISTRIBUTION, TOP OF THE SCALE TO BOTTOM	MEAN	NOT MUCH OR NOT AT ALL
Students	26	 7 · 13 · 4 · 2 · 0	4.0	2
Parents	18	 6 · 9 · 3 · 0 · 0	4.2	0
Leaders	6	Mostly, Mostly, Mostly, Partly, Mostly, Mostly		
Provider	1	Mostly		

The days • Extremely well to Not at all well

Students: How well were you looked after during the trip? • Parents: How well were you kept informed while the trip was away? • Leaders: How well did the day-to-day running go? • Provider: How well prepared were the group and its leaders?

GROUP	ANSWERED	DISTRIBUTION, TOP OF THE SCALE TO BOTTOM	MEAN	NOT VERY WELL OR NOT AT ALL WELL
Students	26	 9 · 12 · 4 · 1 · 0	4.1	1
Parents	18	 3 · 7 · 5 · 3 · 0	3.6	3
Leaders	6	Very well, Fairly well, Very well, Very well, Fairly well, Very well		
Provider	1	Very well		



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The Moments People Raised

Every moment is coded to what it is about, not the words it uses, then clustered and ranked by how many separate respondents raised it. The day comes from the respondent's own answer first and from the itinerary second. A moment marked programming points at the plan, the pace, the provider chosen or what people were told; one marked running points at delivery on the day. Quotes are reproduced as written, with names of individuals removed at coding. D1 is Wednesday, the journey east; D2 Thursday; D3 Friday; D4 Saturday; D5 the overnight return and Sunday morning.

Communication with parents · evening update

7 of 51 · parent, student, the trip leaders

D3 RUNNING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

On D3, parents described waiting for the evening update after the memorial walk, which reached families after ten, later than on the other evenings; the trip leaders described the same gap between the room check and the message home.

"The Friday message came at 10:15. Every other night it was 7 or 8, so I was watching my phone." parent · D3

"my mom texted me asking if we were ok because the update was late" student · D3 · Memorial walk

"The walk ended at 8:45 as planned and the bus reached the hotel at 9:30; the room check came before the message home. A two-line update sent from Lincoln Memorial Circle before boarding would have kept the rhythm families had come to expect." the trip leaders · D3 · Memorial walk

Weather and conditions · cold and rain on the walk

6 of 51 · student, parent

D3 RUNNING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

On D3, students described being cold and wet between the Vietnam Veterans Memorial and the Lincoln Memorial after rain began during the walk, with rain jackets left on the bus; one parent described a student coming home with a cold.

"it started raining at the vietnam wall and my sweatshirt was soaked by the time we got to lincoln" student · D3 · Memorial walk

"Should have brought the rain jacket from the bus. Nobody said." student · D3 · Memorial walk

"She came home with a cold, which I put down to the wet evening at the memorials." parent · D3

The plan · what students were told to expect

5 of 51 · student, the trip leaders

D2 PROGRAMMING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

On D2, students and the trip leaders described a forty-minute security line at the Capitol Visitor Center that left no time for the Supreme Court steps, the stop the plan had marked to drop first; students who had been told about the Supreme Court in class recorded the loss.

"we waited in the capitol line forever and then didn't get to go to the supreme court which we did a whole lesson on" student · D2 · U.S. Capitol

"The Capitol line ran forty minutes at 12:30. The plan allowed for it by dropping the Supreme Court stop, and that worked on the day; what it did not allow for was that students had prepared for the Supreme Court in class and felt the loss more than any other change." the trip leaders · D2 · U.S. Capitol

Wellbeing and pastoral care · rest on the overnight return

5 of 51 · student, parent

D5 PROGRAMMING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

On D5, students described the 2:15 a.m. rest stop waking the whole bus, and parents described students sleeping through Sunday.

"the 2am stop woke everyone up and i couldn't get back to sleep after" student · D5 · New Stanton service plaza

"She slept most of Sunday. I understand why the overnight bus saves a hotel night, but it is a long way for thirteen-year-olds." parent · D5

The Moments People Raised, continued

The remaining moments, including the two raised as things that went well.



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Transport and logistics • arrival time

4 of 51 • parent, the provider

D5 RUNNING MORE THAN ONE GROUP

On D5, parents described the bus arriving at 6:25 a.m., after the window given in the 4:50 message, with families waiting in the lobby; the provider confirmed a slow last leg from the turnpike exit.

"The message said 5:45 to 6:15 and the bus came at 6:25. Not a big deal, but forty minutes in the lobby with a sleeping sibling is long."

parent • D5

"The overnight team held the schedule to Portage. The last leg lost twelve minutes at the Ohio Turnpike exit and the I-480 merge. Next time we set the arrival window five minutes later and send the Portage message with that in mind." the provider • D5 • Portage service plaza to school

Food and dietary needs • meal timing

3 of 51 • student

D3 PROGRAMMING

On D3, students described dinner at five followed by nearly four hours of walking, and being hungry on the bus at 8:45.

"dinner at 5 and then walking till almost 9, i was starving on the bus back" student • D3 • Memorial walk

Educational value • student engagement

6 of 51 • student, parent

SEVERAL DAYS PROGRAMMING WENT WELL MORE THAN ONE GROUP

Across D2 and D3, students and parents described the Archives educator's program and the quiet time after the African American History and Culture galleries as the moments that stayed with them.

"the archives educator let us look at the real constitution up close and explained why the ink is so faded" student • D2 • National Archives

"My son talked about the African American history museum for the whole drive home from school. That does not happen." parent • D3

Supervision and safety • group management

3 of 51 • parent, the provider

SEVERAL DAYS RUNNING WENT WELL MORE THAN ONE GROUP

Parents and the provider described the groups of five and the head counts at every door as the reason the week felt orderly.

"Same chaperone all week, five kids each. She knew where he was every minute and so did I." parent

"The group boarded by chaperone group at every stop and the count closed before I was asked to move. That is not usual." the provider • D1 • Glacier Hills service plaza



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How to Read This Report

Three rated questions on fully labeled five-point scales and one open question. Each group sees its own wording. Under the four questions sits a routed line naming the school's designated welfare contact; nothing written there enters this report.

The four questions, as asked

QUESTION	STUDENTS	PARENTS	LEADERS	PROVIDER	SCALE
Overall	Overall, how was the trip for you?	Overall, how was the trip for your child?	Overall, how did the trip go?	Overall, how did this trip run?	Excellent · Very good · Good · Fair · Poor
The plan	Was the trip like what you were told it would be?	How closely did the trip match what the school told you to expect?	How well did the itinerary hold up in practice?	How realistic was the itinerary as planned, for this group?	Exactly · Mostly · Partly · Not much · Not at all
The days	How well were you looked after during the trip?	How well were you kept informed while the trip was away?	How well did the day-to-day running go?	How well prepared were the group and its leaders?	Extremely well · Very well · Fairly well · Not very well · Not at all well
One moment	Tell us about one moment on the trip that did not go well. What happened?	Tell us about one moment during the trip when you felt worried or unsure. What would have helped?	Describe one moment when the plan and the day came apart. What happened, and what would have helped?	Describe one moment on this trip you would run differently next time, and why.	open, with an optional day

Rules applied to this report

Small groups are withheld. An anonymous group below 5 responses is withheld, numbers and quotes alike; a quote attributed to a group that small identifies its author.

Named debrief. Trip leaders and the provider answered as a debrief, by consent, and are attributed by role. Their answers never enter an anonymous figure.

Distributions before means. The count at the bottom of the scale is printed beside every bar; a mean hides whether a problem is many mild disappointments or a few strong ones.

Moments carry a day and a mark. The day is the respondent's own first, the itinerary second. The mark says whether the moment points at the plan (programming) or at how the day was run (running).

More than one group. A moment reads as raised by more than one group when respondents from two or more groups raised it.

Sentences are drafted, counts are computed. The sentences are drafted from the responses and checked word for word against them; every count, rank and withholding is computed by rule. A sentence that fails a check is not printed.

Welfare content never enters this report. A passage flagged at screening is routed to the school's designated welfare contact and withheld from analysis. It is not counted, ranked, or quoted.

Anonymous by default, minors absolutely. Students carry no identity field. Names appearing in free text are removed at coding.

What this report does not do

It does not recommend, certify, or approve. It states what respondents reported and which part of the trip it touches; the decision on each finding sits with Horizon Ridge School of Cleveland.

It does not establish cause. A moment describes what was experienced, not why.

It reads a sample, not a census: 51 of 67 invited answered, and those who reply are not always representative of those who do not.

It does not measure learning. Outcomes need a before and an after; this instrument records experience and surfaces what did not go to plan.

Instrument v2.0 · engine v2.0 · taxonomy v1.1 · welfare screen by keyword gate and model review · coding and segment linking by rule first and model second · sentences drafted from the responses and checked word for word against them · distributions, counts, ranking and withholding computed by rule · survey window Monday, April 19 to Monday, May 3, 2027, one reminder · issued May 10, 2027 · feeds forward to the 2028 run of this trip. Prepared by ETI360 for Horizon Ridge School of Cleveland; the school runs the survey and ETI360 prepares the summary the school receives.